

SCAFFOLD

TEAMS & MEETINGS

FOR INTACT TEAMS

Decision Rights by Orientation

A template that assigns the stages of a decision to the people energized by each stage. **Decision load gets matched to cognitive wiring**, the way task load already should be.

THE DRAIN

Teams assign decisions by seniority and availability, never by energy, so framing gets done by people drained by ambiguity, commitment gets held by people drained by closure, and the decision limps through every stage owned by someone paying full price to carry it.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The template splits any significant decision into four stages and assigns each to primary energy: framing to WHY wiring, option development to WHY and HOW together, the commitment call to WHAT wiring, and execution detail to HOW. Authority stays wherever the org chart puts it; the cognitive work moves to where it is cheapest and best.

The four stages

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|---------------------------|--|
| 1 Framing | What are we actually deciding, and what does it serve? WHY energy leads. |
| 2 Options | The real alternatives, developed with their mechanics and consequences. WHY and HOW energy together. |
| 3 Commitment | The call, made cleanly and on schedule. WHAT energy leads; this stage must not be held by wiring that resists closure. |
| 4 Execution detail | The decision translated into who-does-what-when. HOW energy leads. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 Use it for decisions that recur or matter.** One-off small calls need no architecture. Quarterly planning, hiring, and roadmap calls do.
- 2 Assign stages from the team map.** The map shows where each energy lives. Stages follow primaries.
- 3 Keep authority explicit and separate.** The stage lead runs the cognitive work; the accountable owner still signs. Confusing the two kills the template.
- 4 Watch the commitment stage.** It is the stage most often held by the wrong wiring, and the reason decisions age. Give it to WHAT energy on purpose.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

This distributes cognitive load, not accountability, and it is not a consensus mechanism; the accountable owner can overrule any stage. It also needs a minimum of profile diversity to work: a team of one wiring will still find the template useful mostly as a map of which stages it should expect to find expensive.

IN THE KIT

Stage assignment template

Worked example (hiring decision)

Authority-vs-stage explainer

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 37 Team MindPrint™ Map · **Tool 13** Decision Deadline Ritual · **Tool 36** Three-Question Kickoff